



IMPROVING DESIGN DECISIONS BEFORE DESIGN STARTS

Understanding how unclear inputs lead to early assumptions
and result in 3 to 5 revision cycles per project

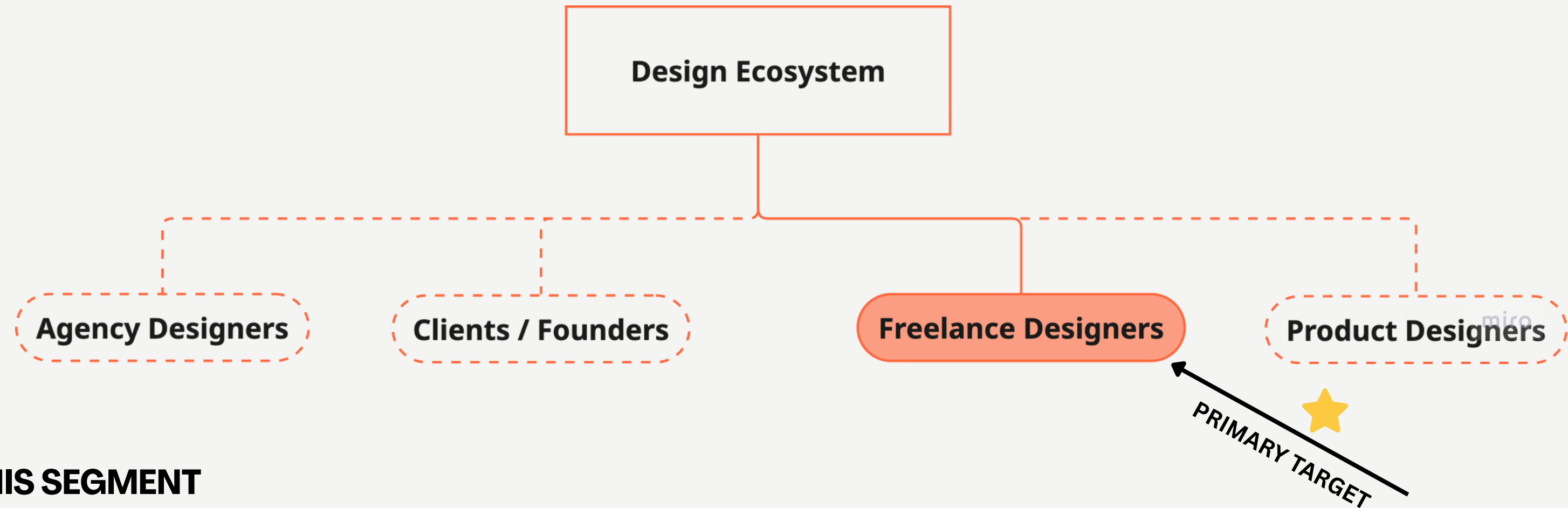
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USER SEGMENTATION



WHY THIS SEGMENT

- All designers face unclear inputs
- Freelance designers handle them directly without structured support
- They own the full project end to end

👉 Leads to **3 to 5 revisions per project**

THE DISCOVERY CALL ENDS. THE BRIEF IS STILL UNCLEAR. DESIGN STARTS ANYWAY.

Clients give vague inputs. 5 to 8 reference links arrive with no context.

There is no structured process to capture what the client actually wants.

The client says: "**Keep it premium.**"

But what does premium actually mean?

Minimal and white space

Bold dark typography

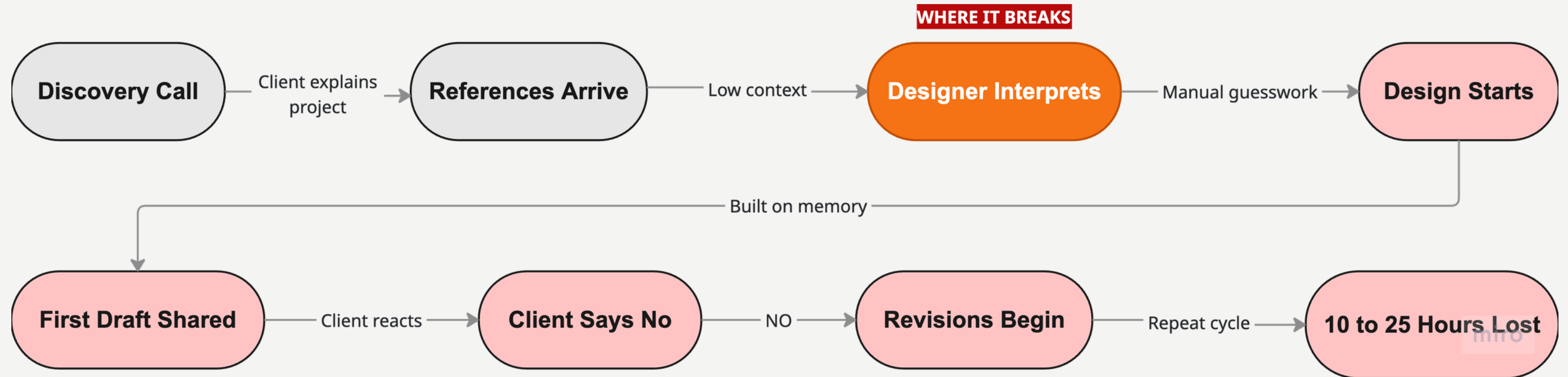
Luxury muted imagery

Every designer interprets it differently. So they guess, design, and wait for feedback.

3 to 5 revision cycles. 12 to 25 hours wasted. Every single project.

Key Insight: This is not a discipline problem. It is a process problem. And process problems have a fix.

HERE IS EXACTLY WHERE THE PROJECT BREAKS.

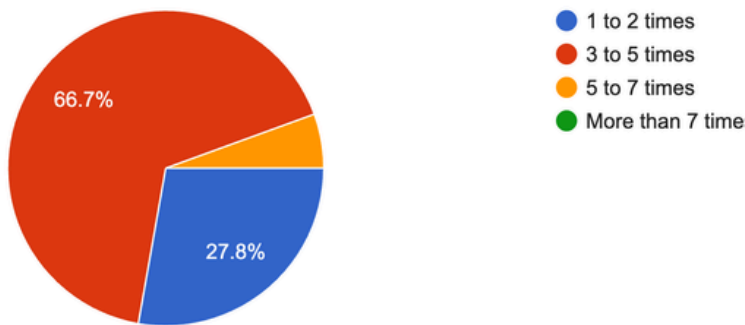


Key Insight: Clients do not know they gave vague inputs. Designers do not say it. The revision cycle is where both sides silently pay for it.

DESIGNERS DON'T LACK CLARITY. THEY LACK ALIGNMENT.

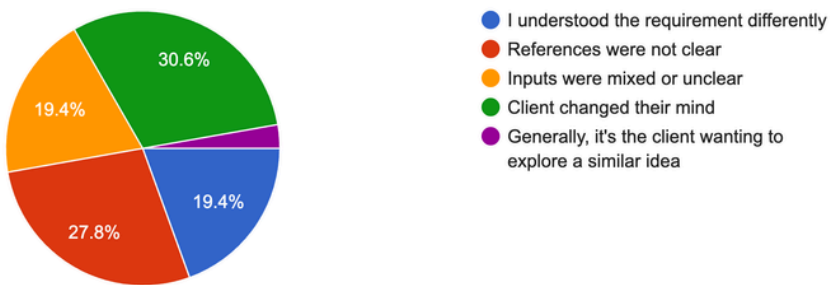
SAMPLE SIZE - 36 DESIGNERS

How many times do you usually revise a design before it gets approved?
36 responses



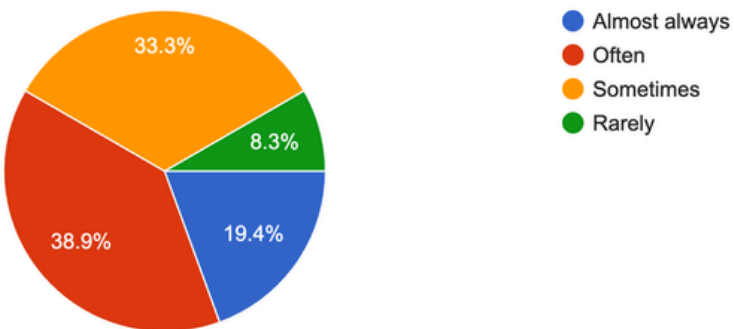
75% go through 3 to 5 revision rounds per project

What usually leads to changes in your design?
36 responses



48% of revisions caused by unclear or misread input.

How often does your first design match what the client expects?
36 responses



1 in 5 designers consistently nail the first draft.

The bottleneck isn't skill. It's the gap between what clients share and what designers actually understand.

“I spend more time guessing what the client wants than actually designing.”

NAME

ARJUN V

JOB

FREELANCE WEB DESIGNER



ARJUN — FREELANCE WEB DESIGNER

GOALS:

- Ship a design the client approves in 1 to 2 rounds
- Start designing with direction, not assumptions

BEHAVIORS:

- Handles 3 to 6 client projects at a time
- Gets references via links, screenshots, and verbal briefs
- Starts designing from memory after a discovery call

FRUSTRATIONS:

- References arrive with less context on what to take.
- Clients say "modern" or "premium" but mean something different every time
- First draft rarely lands, revision cycles eat up the week

Designers don't have a guessing problem. They have a structure problem.

THE OPPORTUNITY ISN'T TO MAKE DESIGNERS BETTER. IT'S TO FIX WHAT THEY START WITH.

THE GAP

Designers lose **12 to 25 hours** per project filling in what the brief never gave them. Not because they lack skill. Because the input capture has no structure.

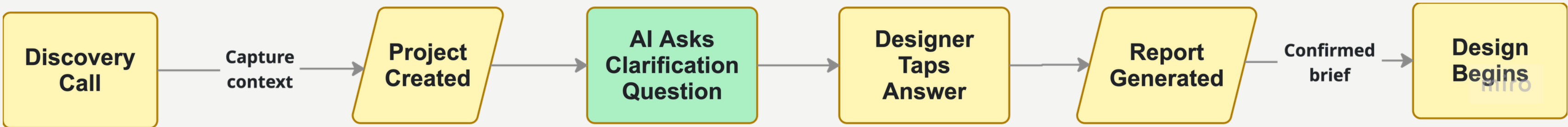
THE GOAL

Reduce revision cycles by **20 to 40%** within 3 months by giving designers a structured, AI-assisted brief before the first pixel is placed.

The problem isn't at the design stage. It's at the input stage. Fix the brief, fix the cycle.

FROM FIRST CALL TO FINAL BRIEF, WITHOUT CHASING CONTEXT TWICE.

Context captured once. No follow-up calls. No assumption-based designs.



FOR DESIGNERS	FOR CLIENTS
• No more designing on assumptions • Ask AI questions mid-design instantly • 20 to 40% fewer revision rounds	• See a clear brief before work starts • Context from the call stays retrievable • First draft aligned to what you actually said

Prototype: <https://theliv.base44.app/>

SUCCESS METRICS TO EVALUATE THELIV

Metric Type	Metric Name	Definition	Why it Matters
Primary Metric	Revision Rounds per Project	Average number of revision rounds per project after using Theliv	Drop from 3 to 5 rounds to 1 to 2 rounds within 3 months of use
Secondary Metric	Designer Satisfaction Score	Percentage of designers who rate the direction report as useful or very useful, collected at project close	70% or above within 6 months of launch
Guardrail Metric	Constraint Violation Rate	Percentage of generated reports that contradict a stated client constraint	Below 5%. Any violation is flagged and blocked before the report is shown

Fewer revision rounds is the outcome. Everything else confirms the system earned it

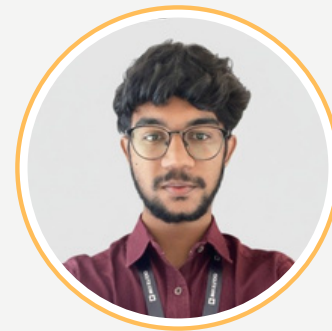
RISKS & MITIGATION STRATEGY

PITFALL	IMPACT	LIKELIHOOD	WHY IT CAN HAPPEN	MITIGATION
Report feels obvious, adds no value	High	High	Vague client inputs produce generic output. The designer already knew all of it.	Before generating, system checks if inputs are specific enough. If not, it asks targeted questions first.
Designer stops using the report mid-project	High	High	Brief lives in Theliv. Design happens in Figma. No connection means the report gets forgotten.	Designer can ask the AI questions during design. "Is dark background allowed?" Context stays alive, not just at project start.
Client changes inputs after report is generated	High	Medium	New reference or updated preference arrives after day one. Report becomes outdated silently.	Report is version-stamped. Any new input triggers a stale alert and prompts the designer to regenerate before continuing.



THANK YOU

Happy to discuss trade-offs, experimentation plan, or rollout strategy.



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